

XML Sitemap Best Practices

How crawlers really read your map

lastmod dates must be accurate. Crawlers learn to ignore sitemaps with stale or identical timestamps.

Exclude noindex pages from your sitemap. Sending mixed signals wastes crawl budget and confuses the index.

Image and video namespaces let you embed media metadata directly in the sitemap for richer indexing.

Split large sitemaps into chunks of under 50,000 URLs and use a sitemap index file to organize them.

**Comment "SITEMAP" for the template. #sitemap
#technicalseo**